

Video. Clicking on some tabs will, however, open new windows in your browser. The number of contacts has been increased from 300 to 600, while a word wheel enables you to quickly search the list. This tool looks not only at names, which can keep changing, but also looks at other data like personal status messages, phone numbers, nicknames, and e-mail IDs. These details can be checked by hovering the cursor over each contact. Notes can be added for each contact, while clicking on the name automatically allows you to start writing mails.

Then there are other features like IM offline contacts, or changing your status to remain hidden, or time-stamping each message. (Use Tools > Options > Messages > Show Time to turn this on.)

WLM has file-sharing capabilities as well. Just drag a file into the message window and it will get shared with the contact. A complete redesign has been effected, with new icons, and the default colour has been set to orange (some other available

colours are red, pink, blue, and yellow). The colours can be changed by clicking on the paintbrush icon at the top of the messenger window. Apart from smileys, winks can be sent to your contacts during a conversation; get them from Tools > Winks. If you're bored of the same bland chat window, you can select a custom background using pictures stored on the local machine. Get this at Tools > Backgrounds.

Windows Live Messenger can be used to make voice calls to other PCs or phones to anywhere in the world. Called Windows Live Call, PC-to-PC calls are free to your contacts. Video calls are also supported in Windows Live Messenger, and even if you don't have a webcam yourself, you can always see



You can choose custom backgrounds for chat windows



You can use plenty of services in Live Messenger